

or a glow etc. The number of things you can do with layers is unlimited but the number of layers you can add is restricted by your system memory.

Use layers to create different “items” on different layers and not mix them or let them destroy each other. Use the layer on/ off toggle and transparency values to determine which of the items on the various is seen, to what extent and in what order. The best part is when you want to edit (like blur, crop, etc.) or remove an item, you need to edit only that layer or remove altogether without affecting the rest of the image. The Layers panel contains a host of features that allows you to play around with your image to your heart's content.

Filters

You can use filters to apply various combinations and effects to your images. The Filter menu provides a plethora of options to “retouch” your image. Blur, distort, noise are just some of the options available here. Play around with the different options available and apply them to an image to see how they work.

To apply a filter to an entire layer, make sure the layer is active or selected. To apply a filter to an area of a layer, select that area. To apply a filter non-



This is the best way of thinking about layers and how they work. And understanding how they work is very important for you to become adept at Photoshop